

# PUBLIC SUBMISSION

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Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

**Comment On:** NSF\_FRDOC\_0001-3479  
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

**Document:** NSF\_FRDOC\_0001-DRAFT-1504  
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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## Submitter Information

**Email:** [REDACTED]  
**Organization:** Ethical Web Data Collection Initiative

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## General Comment

Please find the comments of the Ethical Web Data Collection Initiative attached.

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## Attachments

RFI on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan



VIA ELECTRONIC SUBMISSION

March 14, 2025

Faisal D'Souza  
Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD)  
National Coordination Office (NCO)  
National Science Foundation  
2415 Eisenhower Avenue  
Alexandria, VA 22314

**Re: Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI)  
Action Plan**

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

The Ethical Web Data Collection Initiative (EWDCI) appreciates the opportunity to submit comments in response to the above-referenced Request for Information (RFI) regarding the development of an AI Action Plan. EWDCI is a coalition of industry stakeholders dedicated to promoting responsible and ethical AI data governance, aligning AI policy with principles of transparency, fairness, and accountability. Our work emphasizes and promotes the ethical collection and use of web data in AI model development, ensuring that innovation does not come at the cost of fundamental rights, privacy, or fairness.

**Foundations and Core Principles**

EWDCI recognizes and appreciates the Administration's goal of reducing regulatory burdens to encourage AI innovation. We generally support deregulation as a means to foster innovation and economic growth. However, we urge that this approach be undertaken thoughtfully and strategically to ensure that critical safeguards for transparency, accountability, and data privacy remain intact. A balanced approach to AI governance will support sustainable growth while mitigating the risks associated with unregulated AI deployment. Our recommendations focus on three core principles:

1. **Transparency and Explainability:** AI models should be designed with mechanisms for public accountability and explainability. The AI Action Plan should support policies that

ensure the provenance and integrity of training data, preventing the misuse of ethically questionable or proprietary datasets.

2. **Data Privacy and Security:** AI systems must incorporate robust privacy safeguards from the outset. The AI Action Plan should encourage privacy-preserving AI techniques such as differential privacy, federated learning, and robust encryption measures to ensure that user data is not exploited.
3. **International Collaboration and Standardization:** Given AI's global nature, U.S. leadership should focus on aligning domestic AI policies with international ethical standards, ensuring that AI regulations are interoperable with frameworks such as UNESCO's Recommendation on the Ethics of AI.

## Specific Recommendations

### 1. Open Data and Ethical AI Development

The AI Action Plan should prioritize policies that promote transparent data sourcing, including clear documentation of training datasets. Undocumented, biased, or ethically questionable data sources undermine trust in AI and increase risks of misinformation and discrimination.

### 2. Risk Mitigation and Model Accountability

To ensure AI models do not propagate harm, policies should require:

- **Risk assessments** for high-impact AI systems, particularly those used in hiring, healthcare, and criminal justice.
- **Independent audits** of AI training datasets to prevent data misuse and reinforce ethical AI governance.
- **Clear redress mechanisms** for individuals and organizations negatively affected by AI-driven decisions.
- **Transparency in content moderation and censorship:** Policies should ensure that any censorship or content moderation by AI systems is transparent, subject to independent review, and does not unduly restrict lawful expression.

### 3. Responsible AI Innovation

- The AI Action Plan should support responsible AI innovation by encouraging open-source AI frameworks that adhere to ethical data collection practices.
- Government-funded AI research should emphasize fairness, bias mitigation, and inclusive data practices, ensuring that underrepresented communities are not disproportionately impacted by AI systems.

## Conclusion

EWDCI appreciates OSTP and NITRD NCO's efforts to gather stakeholder input in shaping the AI Action Plan. We strongly support deregulation as a tool for fostering innovation, but stress that such an approach must be coupled with safeguards to protect ethical AI development and data privacy. By prioritizing ethical AI data governance, transparency, and international collaboration, the United States can lead in AI development while safeguarding public trust. We

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look forward to continued engagement in these discussions and stand ready to support efforts to create a balanced, ethical, and sustainable AI ecosystem.

Respectfully submitted,

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